

The homework check-in sheet

A one-page routine for staying involved without doing the work.

1 The four-step routine

Before starting

Ask what the homework is and roughly how long the school expects it to take. That sets a natural stopping point.

During

Stay nearby or check in once. Step in only when the struggle looks unproductive.

If the time runs out

Stop. Send the teacher an honest note that it was not finished in the expected time.

Afterwards

Ask one open question: "What was the hardest part?" Don't check every answer.

2 Ask these before you give the answer

1. "What do you already know that might help here?"
2. "Where exactly did you get stuck? Show me the last thing you were sure about."
3. "What would happen if you tried it this way?"
4. "Is there an example in your notes or textbook that's similar?"
5. "What did your teacher say about this in class?"

3 Wait, or step in?

Wait a few more minutes

They are stuck but still trying different approaches.

Step in briefly

They have stopped trying, are staring at the page, or are getting upset. Give the one missing piece, then let them carry on alone.

4 This week's log

Day	Subject	Time expected	Time it took	The hardest part
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				

If the same subject or topic keeps appearing in the last column, show this log to the subject teacher.